

Figure 2-4. *Verifying/compiling*

Verifying will run the sketch through a process called **compiling**, where the development environment takes the Arduino C code that we have written and translates it into a binary format that the actual microcontroller will understand. If all goes well, a note will appear at the bottom of the window that says, "Done compiling," and you will be told the binary sketch size in bytes. If there is an error during the verification process, skip ahead and check out the section on common errors to see if you can figure out what went wrong. Once we have completed writing our sketch, verified it for errors, and everything completes successfully, we are ready to upload the sketch to the Arduino board; but before we do that, let's save our hard work.

Saving

Once you've got a working sketch that is ready to be uploaded to your Arduino board, or even if it is still in-progress, you should probably save your file frequently. To save a sketch, all we need to do is hit the Save button in the toolbar, as shown in Figure 2-5.